

The Regulatory Timeline: and what of it this data can measure

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September 2026

Abstract

This is an audit, not a causal memo. For each state law and San Francisco ordinance that plausibly bears on the project it asks what the law changed, what in the data would move if it worked as written, whether the treated set can be constructed, and what would confound a comparison. It reports no effect.

45 laws, every date and scope claim quoted from a primary source. The inventory holds 29 California statutes and code sections and 16 San Francisco ordinances; its 156 claims all verify against leginfo, the Board’s ordinance lists and the enacted PDFs. One row, the 25-unit ordinance of July 2026 named in the brief, is unverified: none of the 131 ordinances the Board lists for 2026, through Ordinance 0133-26 (effective 2026-08-23), matches it.

6 laws generate usable variation; 28 are not measurable here. The usable ones are SB 330’s preliminary-application freeze and hearing cap, the inclusionary changes of Proposition C, Ordinance 158-17 and Ordinance 201-23 (measured through the exaction panel), and the Housing Production ordinances (effective 2024-01-14 and 2024-04-22) that removed hearings. Every opt-in pathway — SB 35, SB 423, AB 2011, the density bonus, HOME-SF — is a developer’s choice bundled with labour and affordability conditions, and the permits memo found 31 such permits.

The docket’s composition moved after those ordinances. Residential conditional-use items fell from 29.4 a quarter in 2021–2022 to 22.7 in 2024–2026, and residential discretionary reviews from 19.4 to 13.2. Every series measured on the docket since then is measured on a different sample; the memos that use them need an era split there.

SB 330’s five-hearing cap does not show in the hearing counts. Of residential cases first heard in 2015–2019, 1.9% were heard on more than five dates; of those first heard in 2020–2025, 2.4%, before the later cases have finished.

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1 What this memo is, and is not

A referee will ask why the paper does not use SB 35, or SB 330, or the Housing Production ordinances. This memo is where the answer comes from. For each law it gives four things: what the law changed, in the law’s own words; the observable that must move if the law was implemented at all (the mechanical first stage) and the one that moves only if people responded (the behavioural second stage); whether the projects the law reached can be identified in the data; and what else changed at the same time. It ends with a verdict per law and a shortlist.

It does not estimate anything. Where a series appears to move, the memo says so and says what would have to be true for the movement to be the law’s doing. No event-study coefficient, difference-in-differences or synthetic control appears here.

2 The model objects, and which rows to care about

Each law is assigned to one primary category by the model object it moves, with secondary effects noted:

1. **Arrival of discretion** — whether a project faces a hearing at all (ministerial pathways, removal of conditional-use requirements): 9 laws.
2. **The delay distribution given discretion** — statutory timelines, hearing caps, CEQA constraints: 10.
3. **Stringency in dollars** — inclusionary requirements, fees: 6.
4. **The option’s term and vesting** — the preliminary-application freeze, when fees vest: 3.
5. **The feasible envelope** — density bonuses, upzoning, parking minimums, ADUs: 17.

Categories 1 and 2 are the potential identifying variation for the wedge: they change σ or whether it applies, not the envelope. Category 5 laws are controls. Category 3 is τ and is measured in the exactions memo.

3 Sources and how they were checked

Each law’s facts are claims in `law_claims.csv`: the field, the value, the source URL and a quotation taken from the source’s cached text by a regular expression; dates are read out of the quotation. `probe` re-reads every source; all 156 of 156 claims verify. California statutes are quoted from leginfo’s bill text (chapter, approval date, the Legislative Counsel’s digest, sunset clauses) and code sections; San Francisco ordinances from the enacted PDFs and the Board’s lists.

Effective dates. A San Francisco ordinance’s effective date is the Board’s list. For a California statute the Constitution sets the rule — “go into effect on January 1 next following a 90-day period from the date of enactment of the statute” — and this memo quotes it but does not compute from it, because what counts as the date of enactment is not sourced here. Instead, where a code section the bill added or amended still carries the bill’s own history note, that note’s date is used (5 statutes). In every such note the date is the January 1 after the year of the Governor’s approval, including for SB 79, approved on 2025-10-10 and effective 2026-01-01; the other 18 statutes are given that date and marked as inferred (^{*i*} in Table 1). A bill that says it takes effect immediately takes effect on approval.

Where the Board’s record is now. The Board’s own ordinance lists moved from sfbos.org to sf.gov during 2026; the archived copy stops at Ordinance 52-26. Legistar’s web API for San Francisco carries no matter after 2020. The 2026 list used here is sf.gov’s.

A correction to the brief. The brief lists AB 1763 among the Housing Accountability Act amendments. Its title is “Planning and zoning: density bonuses: affordable housing”; it is filed here under the density bonus (category 5).

Table 1: The law inventory. Dates are read from the quotations (Section 3); a California statute’s effective date is the January 1 after a 90-day period from enactment unless the bill takes effect immediately; San Francisco’s are the Board’s list. Cat.: the model object (Section 2). The full rows, with eligibility and target quotations, are `law_inventory.csv`.

Law	Citation	Enacted	Effective	Operative	Sunset	Cat.	Verified
Permit Streamlining Act	Gov. Code 65920 et seq. (time limits: 65950)	—	—	—	—	2	yes
Housing Accountability Act	Gov. Code 65589.5	—	—	—	—	2/4	yes
SB 167 (HAA)	SB 167 (Skinner), Stats. 2017, ch. 368	2017-09-29	2018-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	2	yes
AB 678 (HAA)	AB 678 (Bocanegra), Stats. 2017, ch. 373	2017-09-29	2018-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	2	yes
AB 1515 (HAA)	AB 1515 (Daly), Stats. 2017, ch. 378	2017-09-29	2018-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	2	yes
Density Bonus Law	Gov. Code 65915	—	—	—	—	5	yes
AB 1763 (density bonus)	AB 1763 (Chiu), Stats. 2019, ch. 666	2019-10-09	2020-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5	yes
AB 2345 (density bonus)	AB 2345 (Gonzalez), Stats. 2020, ch. 197	2020-09-28	2021-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5	yes
SB 35	SB 35 (Wiener), Stats. 2017, ch. 366	2017-09-29	2018-01-01 ⁱ	—	2026-01-01	1	yes
SB 423	SB 423 (Wiener), Stats. 2023, ch. 778	2023-10-11	2024-01-01 ⁱ	—	2036-01-01	1	yes
SB 330 (Housing Crisis Act)	SB 330 (Skinner), Stats. 2019, ch. 654	2019-10-09	2020-01-01 ⁱ	—	2025-01-01	4/2	yes
SB 8	SB 8 (Skinner), Stats. 2021, ch. 161	2021-09-16	2022-01-01 ⁱ	—	2030-01-01	4	yes
SB 9	SB 9 (Atkins), Stats. 2021, ch. 162	2021-09-16	2022-01-01	—	—	5/1	yes
SB 10	SB 10 (Wiener), Stats. 2021, ch. 163	2021-09-16	2022-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5	yes
AB 2011	AB 2011 (Wicks), Stats. 2022, ch. 647	2022-09-28	2023-01-01	2023-07-01	2033-01-01	1/5	yes
SB 6	SB 6 (Caballero), Stats. 2022, ch. 659	2022-09-28	2023-01-01 ⁱ	2023-07-01	2033-01-01	5	yes
AB 2097	AB 2097 (Friedman), Stats. 2022, ch. 459	2022-09-22	2023-01-01	—	—	5	yes
AB 1633	AB 1633 (Ting), Stats. 2023, ch. 768	2023-10-11	2024-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	2	yes
SB 4	SB 4 (Wiener), Stats. 2023, ch. 771	2023-10-11	2024-01-01 ⁱ	—	2036-01-01	1	yes
AB 2243	AB 2243 (Wicks), Stats. 2024, ch. 272	2024-09-19	2025-01-01	—	—	1	yes
AB 68	AB 68 (Ting), Stats. 2019, ch. 655	2019-10-09	2020-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5/1	yes
AB 881	AB 881 (Bloom), Stats. 2019, ch. 659	2019-10-09	2020-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5/1	yes
AB 587	AB 587 (Friedman), Stats. 2019, ch. 657	2019-10-09	2020-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5/1	yes
AB 2221	AB 2221 (Quirk-Silva), Stats. 2022, ch. 650	2022-09-28	2023-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5/1	yes

Law	Citation	Enacted	Effective	Operative	Sunset	Cat.	Verified
SB 897	SB 897 (Wieckowski), Stats. 2022, ch. 664	2022-09-28	2023-01-01 ⁱ	—	—	5/1	yes
AB 130 (2025 budget trailer: housing)	AB 130 (Committee on Budget), Stats. 2025, ch. 22	2025-06-30	2025-06-30	—	—	2/1	yes
SB 131 (2025 budget trailer: CEQA)	SB 131 (Committee on Budget and Fiscal Review), Stats. 2025, ch. 24	2025-06-30	2025-06-30	—	—	2	yes
SB 79	SB 79 (Wiener), Stats. 2025, ch. 512	2025-10-10	2026-01-01	2026-07-01	—	5	yes
Housing Element revision schedule	Gov. Code 65588	—	—	—	—	5/1	yes
Proposition C and Ord. 76-16	Ord. 76-16 (File 160255)	2016-05-03	2016-06-12	—	—	3	yes
Ord. 158-17 (inclusionary)	Ord. 158-17 (File 161351)	2017-07-18	2017-08-26	—	—	3	yes
Ord. 193-23 (fee vesting and waivers)	Ord. 193-23 (File 230764)	2023-09-05	2023-10-16	—	—	4/3	yes
Ord. 201-23 (fee reductions)	Ord. 201-23 (File 230855)	2023-10-03	2023-11-12	—	—	3/4	yes
HOME-SF	Ord. 116-17 (File 150969)	2017-06-06	2017-07-13	—	—	5/1	yes
Housing Element 2022 Update	Ord. 10-23 (File 230001)	2023-01-31	2023-03-03	—	—	5/1	yes
Family Housing Opportunity SUD	Ord. 195-23 (File 230026)	2023-09-05	2023-10-16	—	—	1/5	yes
Housing Production (Ord. 248-23)	Ord. 248-23 (File 230446)	2023-12-12	2024-01-14	—	—	1	yes
Housing Production (Ord. 53-24)	Ord. 53-24 (File 231258)	2024-03-12	2024-04-22	—	—	1	yes
Family Zoning Plan	Ord. 245-25 (File 250701)	2025-12-09	2026-01-12	—	—	5/1	yes
Inclusionary waiver for rent control (Ord. 260-25)	Ord. 260-25 (File 250815)	2025-12-16	2026-01-23	—	—	3	yes
Impact-fee deferral (Ord. 196-25)	Ord. 196-25 (File 250657)	2025-10-21	2025-11-24	—	—	3/4	yes
Site-permit streamlining (Ord. 154-23)	Ord. 154-23 (File 230374)	2023-07-25	2023-08-28	—	—	2	yes
CU appeals (Ord. 191-22)	Ord. 191-22 (File 220130)	2022-09-06	2022-10-17	—	—	2	yes
Minimum densities (Ord. 292-24)	Ord. 292-24 (File 230596)	2024-12-17	2025-01-19	—	—	1/5	yes
The 25-unit ordinance of July 2026 (brief)	not found	—	—	—	—	3	unverified

4 Measurability, law by law

The entries follow the categories. “In its own words” is the verified quotation of the law’s title or digest, and of its eligibility or operative provision where one was taken; the rest is this memo’s reading of the data.

4.1 Category 1: arrival of discretion

SB 35 *SB 35 (Wiener), Stats. 2017, ch. 366; effective 2018-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 35, Wiener. Planning and zoning: affordable housing:

streamlined approval process.” — “subject to a requirement mandating a minimum percentage of below market rate housing based on one of the following”. *Treated set*. Projects that file under it: the Planning records’ SB 35 flag, and the text. Eligibility (affordability, labour standards, site exclusions) is not constructible. SB 35 flag + text: 13 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. Applications filed under the pathway, by quarter; approval within the statutory window without a hearing. *Behavioural second stage*. Share of eligible-looking projects that choose it; time to permit. *Unobserved*. Eligibility, and the labour and affordability commitments. *Confounds*. An opt-in pathway bundled with labour and affordability conditions; SB 423 changed it in 2024. *Verdict*: **partially usable**.

SB 423 *SB 423 (Wiener), Stats. 2023, ch. 778; effective 2024-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “SB 423, Wiener. Land use: streamlined housing approvals: multifamily housing developments.”. *Treated set*. As SB 35; the records have no SB 423 field, only the text. SB 423 in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. As SB 35. *Behavioural second stage*. As SB 35. *Unobserved*. As SB 35. *Confounds*. Housing Element rezoning, the 2024 Housing Production ordinance. *Verdict*: **partially usable**.

AB 2011 *AB 2011 (Wicks), Stats. 2022, ch. 647; effective 2023-01-01; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “AB 2011, Wicks. Affordable Housing and High Road Jobs Act of 2022.” — “use by right and subject to one of 2 streamlined, ministerial review processes”. *Treated set*. Commercial-zone housing projects electing it; site, corridor and labour criteria are not constructible; found by text. AB 2011 in text: 5 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. Applications under it, by quarter. *Behavioural second stage*. Housing on commercial parcels. *Unobserved*. Eligibility. *Confounds*. SB 6 (same year), AB 2243 (2024). *Verdict*: **partially usable**.

SB 4 *SB 4 (Wiener), Stats. 2023, ch. 771; effective 2024-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “SB 4, Wiener. Planning and zoning: housing development: higher education institutions and religious institutions.” — “use by right upon the request of an applicant who submits an application for streamlined approval, on any land owned by an independent institution of higher education or religious institution”. *Treated set*. Projects on such land; ownership is not in the data. SB 4 in text: 0 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. — *Behavioural second stage*. — *Unobserved*. Ownership, election. *Confounds*. — *Verdict*: **not measurable here**.

AB 2243 *AB 2243 (Wicks), Stats. 2024, ch. 272; effective 2025-01-01; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “AB 2243, Wicks. Housing development projects: objective standards: affordability and site criteria.”. *Treated set*. As AB 2011. *Mechanical first stage*. As AB 2011. *Behavioural second stage*. — *Unobserved*. As AB 2011. *Confounds*. An amendment; no separate variation. *Verdict*: **not measurable here**.

Family Housing Opportunity SUD *Ord. 195-23 (File 230026); effective 2023-10-16; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “create the Family Housing Opportunity Special Use District”. *Treated set*. RH parcels in the SUD (a zoning-panel join); eligibility conditions partly constructible. FHO SUD in text: 2 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. Discretionary reviews and CUs for RH projects in the SUD, by quarter. *Behavioural second stage*. Multi-unit

filings in RH districts. *Unobserved*. Eligibility details. *Confounds*. The 2024 Housing Production ordinance. *Verdict*: **partially usable**.

Housing Production (Ord. 248-23) *Ord. 248-23 (File 230446); effective 2024-01-14; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “exempting, under certain conditions, specified housing projects from the notice and review procedures of Section 311 and the Conditional Use requirement of Section 317”. *Treated set*. Residential items on the docket; the Priority Equity Geographies SUD is a polygon not yet joined. residential CU items: 99 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. Residential CU and DR items per quarter, before and after. *Behavioural second stage*. Filings of the exempted project types. *Unobserved*. Which projects the exemptions reached. *Confounds*. Ord. 53-24 four months later; the Housing Element. *Verdict*: **usable**.

Housing Production (Ord. 53-24) *Ord. 53-24 (File 231258); effective 2024-04-22; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “exempting, under certain conditions, specified housing projects from the notice and review procedures of Section 311”. *Treated set*. As 248-23. residential CU items: 99 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage*. As 248-23. *Behavioural second stage*. As 248-23. *Unobserved*. As 248-23. *Confounds*. 248-23. *Verdict*: **usable**.

Minimum densities (Ord. 292-24) *Ord. 292-24 (File 230596); effective 2025-01-19; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “require conditional use authorization for residential housing developments that do not maximize minimum residential density”. *Treated set*. Projects in RM/RC/RTO below minimum density (zoning panel and unit counts). *Mechanical first stage*. CUs for under-density projects. *Behavioural second stage*. Unit counts. *Unobserved*. The minimum density per parcel. *Confounds*. The Family Zoning Plan. *Verdict*: **partially usable**.

4.2 Category 2: delay given discretion

Permit Streamlining Act *Gov. Code 65920 et seq. (time limits: 65950); effective not established; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “shall approve or disapprove the project within whichever of the following periods is applicable”. *Treated set*. All development projects; the clock runs from the lead agency’s CEQA document or completeness determination, neither of which is in the data. *Mechanical first stage*. Days from CEQA certification (or exemption) to approval, capped by the statute; the start date is not recorded. *Behavioural second stage*. — *Unobserved*. The CEQA completion and completeness dates. *Confounds*. — *Verdict*: **not measurable here**.

Housing Accountability Act *Gov. Code 65589.5; effective not established; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “This section shall be known, and may be cited, as the Housing Accountability Act”. *Treated set*. Housing projects consistent with objective standards; consistency is not a field. *Mechanical first stage*. Disapprovals or density reductions of compliant projects; the docket records disapprovals but not compliance. *Behavioural second stage*. Filing of projects that rely on it. *Unobserved*. Compliance with objective standards. *Confounds*. Amended repeatedly (SB 167, AB 678, AB 1515, SB 330, AB 1633). *Verdict*: **not measurable here**.

SB 167 (HAA) *SB 167 (Skinner), Stats. 2017, ch. 368; effective 2018-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed*. In its own words: “SB 167, Skinner. Housing Accountability

Act.” — “This bill would require the findings of the local agency to instead be based on a preponderance of the evidence in the record”. *Treated set.* As the HAA. *Mechanical first stage.* As the HAA. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* As the HAA. *Confounds.* Enacted with AB 678 and AB 1515. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 678 (HAA) *AB 678 (Bocanegra), Stats. 2017, ch. 373; effective 2018-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 678, Bocanegra. Housing Accountability Act.”. *Treated set.* As the HAA. *Mechanical first stage.* As the HAA. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* As the HAA. *Confounds.* Enacted with SB 167 and AB 1515. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 1515 (HAA) *AB 1515 (Daly), Stats. 2017, ch. 378; effective 2018-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 1515, Daly. Planning and zoning: housing.”. *Treated set.* As the HAA. *Mechanical first stage.* As the HAA. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* As the HAA. *Confounds.* Enacted with SB 167 and AB 678. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 1633 *AB 1633 (Ting), Stats. 2023, ch. 768; effective 2024-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 1633, Ting. Housing Accountability Act: disapprovals: California Environmental Quality Act.” — “fails to make a determination of whether the project is exempt from CEQA or commits an abuse of discretion”. *Treated set.* As the HAA. *Mechanical first stage.* CEQA delay on compliant projects; CEQA dates are not recorded. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* CEQA dates. *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 130 (2025 budget trailer: housing) *AB 130 (Committee on Budget), Stats. 2025, ch. 22; effective 2025-06-30; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 130, Committee on Budget. Housing.” — “this division does not apply to any aspect of a housing development project”. *Treated set.* Infill projects exempt from CEQA under it; the exemption is not a field. *Mechanical first stage.* CEQA document type on PRJ records. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* Eligibility. *Confounds.* SB 131 (same day); too recent. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

SB 131 (2025 budget trailer: CEQA) *SB 131 (Committee on Budget and Fiscal Review), Stats. 2025, ch. 24; effective 2025-06-30; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 131, Committee on Budget and Fiscal Review. Public Resources.” — “This division does not apply to a rezoning that implements the schedule of actions contained in an approved housing element”. *Treated set.* As specified; not a field. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* AB 130; too recent. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

Site-permit streamlining (Ord. 154-23) *Ord. 154-23 (File 230374); effective 2023-08-28; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “define and limit the scope of Building Official review of site permits”. *Treated set.* Site permits (DBI’s site-permit flag). *Mechanical first stage.* Days from filing to issuance of site permits, before and after. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* DBI staffing, the permit backlog. *Verdict: partially usable.*

CU appeals (Ord. 191-22) *Ord. 191-22 (File 220130); effective 2022-10-17; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “allow the signatures of Verified Tenants to count towards the threshold needed to permit an appeal of a Conditional Use authorization”. *Treated set.* CU appeals; the Board’s appeal docket is not in the data. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* Appeals. *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

4.3 Category 3: stringency in dollars

Proposition C and Ord. 76-16 *Ord. 76-16 (File 160255); effective 2016-06-12; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “will become effective only on the effective date of the 16 Charter amendment revising Section 16.110 at the June 7, 2016 election”. *Treated set.* Every project of ten or more units: the exaction panel. *Mechanical first stage.* The vested inclusionary share (the exaction panel). *Behavioural second stage.* Filing around the cutoffs; unit counts at the tiers. *Unobserved.* Tenure for most projects. *Confounds.* 158-17 fourteen months later. *Verdict: usable.*

Ord. 158-17 (inclusionary) *Ord. 158-17 (File 161351); effective 2017-08-26; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “following voter approval of Proposition Cat the June 7, 2016 election”. *Treated set.* As Prop C. *Mechanical first stage.* As Prop C. *Behavioural second stage.* As Prop C. *Unobserved.* As Prop C. *Confounds.* The escalation keyed to the EEA date. *Verdict: usable.*

Ord. 201-23 (fee reductions) *Ord. 201-23 (File 230855); effective 2023-11-12; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “reduce Article 4 development impact fees, including Inclusionary Affordable Housing fees”. *Treated set.* Approval dates and first construction documents: the exaction panel. *Mechanical first stage.* The share of approved projects reaching a first construction document within 30 months. *Behavioural second stage.* The same, against projects approved before the window. *Unobserved.* Which pipeline projects requested the modification. *Confounds.* Interest rates, 193-23. *Verdict: usable.*

Inclusionary waiver for rent control (Ord. 260-25) *Ord. 260-25 (File 250815); effective 2026-01-23; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “allow the City to waive the Inclusionary Housing Fee and other requirements”. *Treated set.* Too recent. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

Impact-fee deferral (Ord. 196-25) *Ord. 196-25 (File 250657); effective 2025-11-24; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “postponing the collection of development impact fees for designated residential development projects”. *Treated set.* Too recent. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

The 25-unit ordinance of July 2026 (brief) *not found; effective not established; opt-in: —; verified: unverified. What it changed.* Not established: no quotation verified. *Treated set.* Not identified. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* The law itself. *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

4.4 Category 4: option term and vesting

SB 330 (Housing Crisis Act) *SB 330 (Skinner), Stats. 2019, ch. 654; effective 2020-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 330, Skinner. Housing Crisis Act of 2019.” — “more than five hearings pursuant to Section 65905”. *Treated set.* Housing projects; preliminary applications are flagged on PRJ records (the SB 330 field). SB 330 flag (PRJ): 27 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage.* (i) Preliminary applications by quarter; (ii) for housing cases, the share heard more than five times, before and after the operative date. *Behavioural second stage.* Filing timing relative to local rule changes. *Unobserved.* Which hearings SB 330 counts; completeness dates. *Confounds.* The pandemic (2020), the Housing Element cycle. *Verdict: usable.*

SB 8 *SB 8 (Skinner), Stats. 2021, ch. 161; effective 2022-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 8, Skinner. Housing Crisis Act of 2019.”. *Treated set.* As SB 330. *Mechanical first stage.* As SB 330. *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* As SB 330. *Confounds.* An extension; no new variation. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

Ord. 193-23 (fee vesting and waivers) *Ord. 193-23 (File 230764); effective 2023-10-16; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “provide that the type and rates of applicable development impact fees, with the exception of inclusionary housing fees, shall be determined at the time of project approval”. *Treated set.* Every project owing impact fees; the waiver districts are in the zoning panel. *Mechanical first stage.* The vesting date of fees (the exaction panel). *Behavioural second stage.* Timing of approvals and permits. *Unobserved.* Which projects took the waiver. *Confounds.* 201-23 a month later. *Verdict: partially usable.*

4.5 Category 5: feasible envelope

Density Bonus Law *Gov. Code 65915; effective not established; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “shall grant one density bonus, the amount of which shall be as specified in subdivision (f)”. *Treated set.* Projects that claim a bonus. The Planning records’ density-bonus field is empty; claims are found by text, and the pipeline dataset flags current projects. density bonus in text: 58 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage.* Bonus units granted; not recorded. *Behavioural second stage.* Project size and affordable share. *Unobserved.* The bonus, the concessions and waivers granted. *Confounds.* HOME-SF, the local alternative, and AB 2345. *Verdict: partially usable.*

AB 1763 (density bonus) *AB 1763 (Chiu), Stats. 2019, ch. 666; effective 2020-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 1763, Chiu. Planning and zoning: density bonuses: affordable housing.”. *Treated set.* 100% affordable projects claiming a bonus; the claim is not a field. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* The bonus. *Confounds.* The brief lists it among the HAA amendments; its own title is the density bonus. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 2345 (density bonus) *AB 2345 (Gonzalez), Stats. 2020, ch. 197; effective 2021-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 2345, Gonzalez. Planning and zoning: density bonuses: annual report: affordable housing.”. *Treated set.* As the Density Bonus Law. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* The bonus. *Confounds.* As the Density Bonus Law. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

SB 9 *SB 9 (Atkins), Stats. 2021, ch. 162; effective 2022-01-01; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 9, Atkins. Housing development: approvals.” — “shall ministerially approve, as set forth in this section, a parcel map for an urban lot split”. *Treated set.* Lot splits and two-unit projects in single-family zones; found only by text. SB 9 or lot split in text: 15 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage.* Urban lot splits and SB 9 duplexes filed, by quarter. *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in RH-1 districts. *Unobserved.* The election of the pathway, except by text. *Confounds.* The Family Housing Opportunity SUD (2023). *Verdict: partially usable.*

SB 10 *SB 10 (Wiener), Stats. 2021, ch. 163; effective 2022-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 10, Wiener. Planning and zoning: housing development: density.” — “up to 10 units of residential density per parcel, at a height specified in the ordinance”. *Treated set.* Parcels a local ordinance upzones under it; no such San Francisco ordinance was looked for. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* Adoption. *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

SB 6 *SB 6 (Caballero), Stats. 2022, ch. 659; effective 2023-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 6, Caballero. Local planning: housing: commercial zones.” — “allowable use on a parcel that is within a zone where office, retail, or parking are a principally permitted use”. *Treated set.* Housing on commercial parcels electing it; not a field. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* Election. *Confounds.* AB 2011. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 2097 *AB 2097 (Friedman), Stats. 2022, ch. 459; effective 2023-01-01; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 2097, Friedman. Residential, commercial, or other development types: parking requirements.” — “shall not impose or enforce any minimum automobile parking requirement on a residential, commercial, or other development project if the project is located within one-half mile of public transit”. *Treated set.* Projects near transit; no transit layer is joined. *Mechanical first stage.* Parking per unit (PRJ records from 2018). *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* Transit proximity; parking before 2018. *Confounds.* San Francisco had already removed most minimums (not sourced here). *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 68 *AB 68 (Ting), Stats. 2019, ch. 655; effective 2020-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 68, Ting. Land use: accessory dwelling units.” — “ministerially approve or deny a permit application for the creation of an accessory dwelling unit or junior accessory dwelling unit within 60 days”. *Treated set.* ADU permits: DBI’s ADU flag and the text. DBI ADU permits: 182 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage.* ADU permits filed, by quarter (the 2020 state package; the 2023 local conformity). *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in existing buildings. *Unobserved.* Which statute a permit relied on. *Confounds.* Five statutes in four years, San Francisco’s own ADU ordinances, the pandemic. *Verdict: partially usable.*

AB 881 *AB 881 (Bloom), Stats. 2019, ch. 659; effective 2020-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 881, Bloom. Accessory dwelling units.”. *Treated set.* ADU permits: DBI’s ADU flag and the text. *Mechanical first stage.* ADU permits filed, by quarter (the 2020 state package; the 2023 local conformity). *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in existing buildings. *Unobserved.* Which statute a permit relied on. *Confounds.*

Five statutes in four years, San Francisco’s own ADU ordinances, the pandemic. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 587 *AB 587 (Friedman), Stats. 2019, ch. 657; effective 2020-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 587, Friedman. Accessory dwelling units: sale or separate conveyance.”. *Treated set.* ADU permits: DBI’s ADU flag and the text. *Mechanical first stage.* ADU permits filed, by quarter (the 2020 state package; the 2023 local conformity). *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in existing buildings. *Unobserved.* Which statute a permit relied on. *Confounds.* Five statutes in four years, San Francisco’s own ADU ordinances, the pandemic. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

AB 2221 *AB 2221 (Quirk-Silva), Stats. 2022, ch. 650; effective 2023-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “AB 2221, Quirk-Silva. Accessory dwelling units.”. *Treated set.* ADU permits: DBI’s ADU flag and the text. *Mechanical first stage.* ADU permits filed, by quarter (the 2020 state package; the 2023 local conformity). *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in existing buildings. *Unobserved.* Which statute a permit relied on. *Confounds.* Five statutes in four years, San Francisco’s own ADU ordinances, the pandemic. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

SB 897 *SB 897 (Wieckowski), Stats. 2022, ch. 664; effective 2023-01-01 (inferred); opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 897, Wieckowski. Accessory dwelling units: junior accessory dwelling units.”. *Treated set.* ADU permits: DBI’s ADU flag and the text. *Mechanical first stage.* ADU permits filed, by quarter (the 2020 state package; the 2023 local conformity). *Behavioural second stage.* Units added in existing buildings. *Unobserved.* Which statute a permit relied on. *Confounds.* Five statutes in four years, San Francisco’s own ADU ordinances, the pandemic. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

SB 79 *SB 79 (Wiener), Stats. 2025, ch. 512; effective 2026-01-01; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “SB 79, Wiener. Housing development: transit-oriented development.”. *Treated set.* Parcels near qualifying stops; too recent. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* Ord. 82-26, the Family Zoning Plan. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

Housing Element revision schedule *Gov. Code 65588; effective not established; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “Each local government shall review its housing element as frequently as appropriate”. *Treated set.* The whole city. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* The due dates. *Confounds.* — *Verdict: not measurable here.*

HOME-SF *Ord. 116-17 (File 150969); effective 2017-07-13; opt-in: yes; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “to add the Local Affordable Housing Bonus HOME-SF 5 Program”. *Treated set.* Projects electing it, by text; the 2019 ordinance added a HOME-SF Project Authorization (not read). HOME-SF in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025. *Mechanical first stage.* HOME-SF applications by quarter. *Behavioural second stage.* Project size. *Unobserved.* Election except by text. *Confounds.* The state density bonus; 2023 amendments. *Verdict: partially usable.*

Housing Element 2022 Update *Ord. 10-23 (File 230001); effective 2023-03-03; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “adopting the Housing Element 2022 Update as the Housing Element of the General Plan”. *Treated set.* The whole city. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* Every 2023–2025 ordinance implements it. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

Family Zoning Plan *Ord. 245-25 (File 250701); effective 2026-01-12; opt-in: no; verified: yes. What it changed.* In its own words: “create the Housing Choice-San Francisco Program to incent housing development through a local bonus program”. *Treated set.* Rezoned parcels; too recent. *Mechanical first stage.* — *Behavioural second stage.* — *Unobserved.* — *Confounds.* SB 79 and Ord. 82-26. *Verdict: not measurable here.*

5 Summary and shortlist

Table 2: Summary: one row per law. Treated set: whether the data can say which projects the law reached. Population: projects or records a year where the data counts them (records and permits through 2025).

Law	Cat.	Treated set / population	Verdict
Housing Production (Ord. 248-23)	1	Residential items on the docket; the Priority Equity Geographies SUD is a polygon not yet joined. residential CU items: 99 a year, 2021–2025.	usable
Housing Production (Ord. 53-24)	1	As 248-23. residential CU items: 99 a year, 2021–2025.	usable
Proposition C and Ord. 76-16	3	Every project of ten or more units: the exaction panel.	usable
Ord. 158-17 (inclusionary)	3	As Prop C.	usable
Ord. 201-23 (fee reductions)	3	Approval dates and first construction documents: the exaction panel.	usable
SB 330 (Housing Crisis Act)	4	Housing projects; preliminary applications are flagged on PRJ records (the SB 330 field). SB 330 flag (PRJ): 27 a year, 2021–2025.	usable
SB 35	1	Projects that file under it: the Planning records’ SB 35 flag, and the text. Eligibility (affordability, labour standards, site exclusions) is not constructible. SB 35 flag + text: 13 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
SB 423	1	As SB 35; the records have no SB 423 field, only the text. SB 423 in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
AB 2011	1	Commercial-zone housing projects electing it; site, corridor and labour criteria are not constructible; found by text. AB 2011 in text: 5 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable

Law	Cat.	Treated set / population	Verdict
Family Housing Opportunity SUD	1	RH parcels in the SUD (a zoning-panel join); eligibility conditions partly constructible. FHO SUD in text: 2 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
Minimum densities (Ord. 292-24)	1	Projects in RM/RC/RTO below minimum density (zoning panel and unit counts).	partially usable
Site-permit streamlining (Ord. 154-23)	2	Site permits (DBI's site-permit flag).	partially usable
Ord. 193-23 (fee vesting and waivers)	4	Every project owing impact fees; the waiver districts are in the zoning panel.	partially usable
Density Bonus Law	5	Projects that claim a bonus. The Planning records' density-bonus field is empty; claims are found by text, and the pipeline dataset flags current projects. density bonus in text: 58 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
SB 9	5	Lot splits and two-unit projects in single-family zones; found only by text. SB 9 or lot split in text: 15 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
AB 68	5	ADU permits: DBI's ADU flag and the text. DBI ADU permits: 182 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
HOME-SF	5	Projects electing it, by text; the 2019 ordinance added a HOME-SF Project Authorization (not read). HOME-SF in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025.	partially usable
SB 4	1	Projects on such land; ownership is not in the data. SB 4 in text: 0 a year, 2021–2025.	not measurable here
AB 2243	1	As AB 2011.	not measurable here
Permit Streamlining Act	2	All development projects; the clock runs from the lead agency's CEQA document or completeness determination, neither of which is in the data.	not measurable here
Housing Accountability Act	2	Housing projects consistent with objective standards; consistency is not a field.	not measurable here
SB 167 (HAA)	2	As the HAA.	not measurable here
AB 678 (HAA)	2	As the HAA.	not measurable here
AB 1515 (HAA)	2	As the HAA.	not measurable here
AB 1633	2	As the HAA.	not measurable here

Law	Cat.	Treated set / population	Verdict
AB 130 (2025 budget trailer: housing)	2	Infill projects exempt from CEQA under it; the exemption is not a field.	not measurable here
SB 131 (2025 budget trailer: CEQA)	2	As specified; not a field.	not measurable here
CU appeals (Ord. 191-22)	2	CU appeals; the Board's appeal docket is not in the data.	not measurable here
Inclusionary waiver for rent control (Ord. 260-25)	3	Too recent.	not measurable here
Impact-fee deferral (Ord. 196-25)	3	Too recent.	not measurable here
The 25-unit ordinance of July 2026 (brief)	3	Not identified.	not measurable here
SB 8	4	As SB 330.	not measurable here
AB 1763 (density bonus)	5	100% affordable projects claiming a bonus; the claim is not a field.	not measurable here
AB 2345 (density bonus)	5	As the Density Bonus Law.	not measurable here
SB 10	5	Parcels a local ordinance upzones under it; no such San Francisco ordinance was looked for.	not measurable here
SB 6	5	Housing on commercial parcels electing it; not a field.	not measurable here
AB 2097	5	Projects near transit; no transit layer is joined.	not measurable here
AB 881	5	ADU permits: DBI's ADU flag and the text.	not measurable here
AB 587	5	ADU permits: DBI's ADU flag and the text.	not measurable here
AB 2221	5	ADU permits: DBI's ADU flag and the text.	not measurable here
SB 897	5	ADU permits: DBI's ADU flag and the text.	not measurable here
SB 79	5	Parcels near qualifying stops; too recent.	not measurable here

Law	Cat.	Treated set / population	Verdict
Housing Element revision schedule	5	The whole city.	not measurable here
Housing Element 2022 Update	5	The whole city.	not measurable here
Family Zoning Plan	5	Rezoned parcels; too recent.	not measurable here

The shortlist. The laws that come out usable are: SB 330 (Housing Crisis Act); Proposition C and Ord. 76-16; Ord. 158-17 (inclusionary); Ord. 201-23 (fee reductions); Housing Production (Ord. 248-23); Housing Production (Ord. 53-24). SB 330 identifies two things — a vesting change (the preliminary application fixes the standards and fees) and a cap on hearings — both with a constructible first stage. The inclusionary changes are the cleanest stringency variation in the project and are measured, with their vesting rules, in the exactions memo. The Housing Production ordinances removed conditional-use and notice requirements for specified housing projects; their first stage is the docket itself (Section 7), and the treated set needs the Priority Equity Geographies polygon joined to parcels, which is the next step.

What the opt-in pathways cannot do. SB 35, SB 423, AB 2011, SB 4, the density bonus and HOME-SF are elections. A project that uses one has chosen it, and has accepted the affordability and labour conditions that come with it; the choice is the outcome, not the assignment. The data can count the elections — SB 35 flag + text: 13 a year, 2021–2025; SB 423 in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025; density bonus in text: 58 a year, 2021–2025; HOME-SF in text: 7 a year, 2021–2025 — and the permits memo found 31 ministerial permits in DBI. They are descriptive material.

6 The raw series

Figure 1 plots the first stages the data can see. They are descriptions.

- **SB 35 and SB 423.** Records naming either pathway are few until SB 423 and rise after it; SB 35 flag + text: 13 a year, 2021–2025. That the rise follows SB 423 is consistent with the extension and its changes mattering, and equally with the Housing Element rezoning of the same period.
- **SB 330.** Preliminary applications appear after its effective date (2020-01-01, inferred), rise, and fall back; SB 330 flag (PRJ): 27 a year, 2021–2025. The hearing counts do not fall: 18 of 964 residential cases first heard in 2015–2019 were heard more than five times, and 22 of 935 first heard in 2020–2025. For the cap to be visible the count would have to be of the hearings SB 330 counts, on the projects it covers (those with a preliminary application), and neither is established; continuances are hearing dates here.
- **ADUs.** DBI’s ADU permits rise before the state package and fall after it; DBI ADU permits: 182 a year, 2021–2025. The state statutes do not produce a visible step against the local program already running.

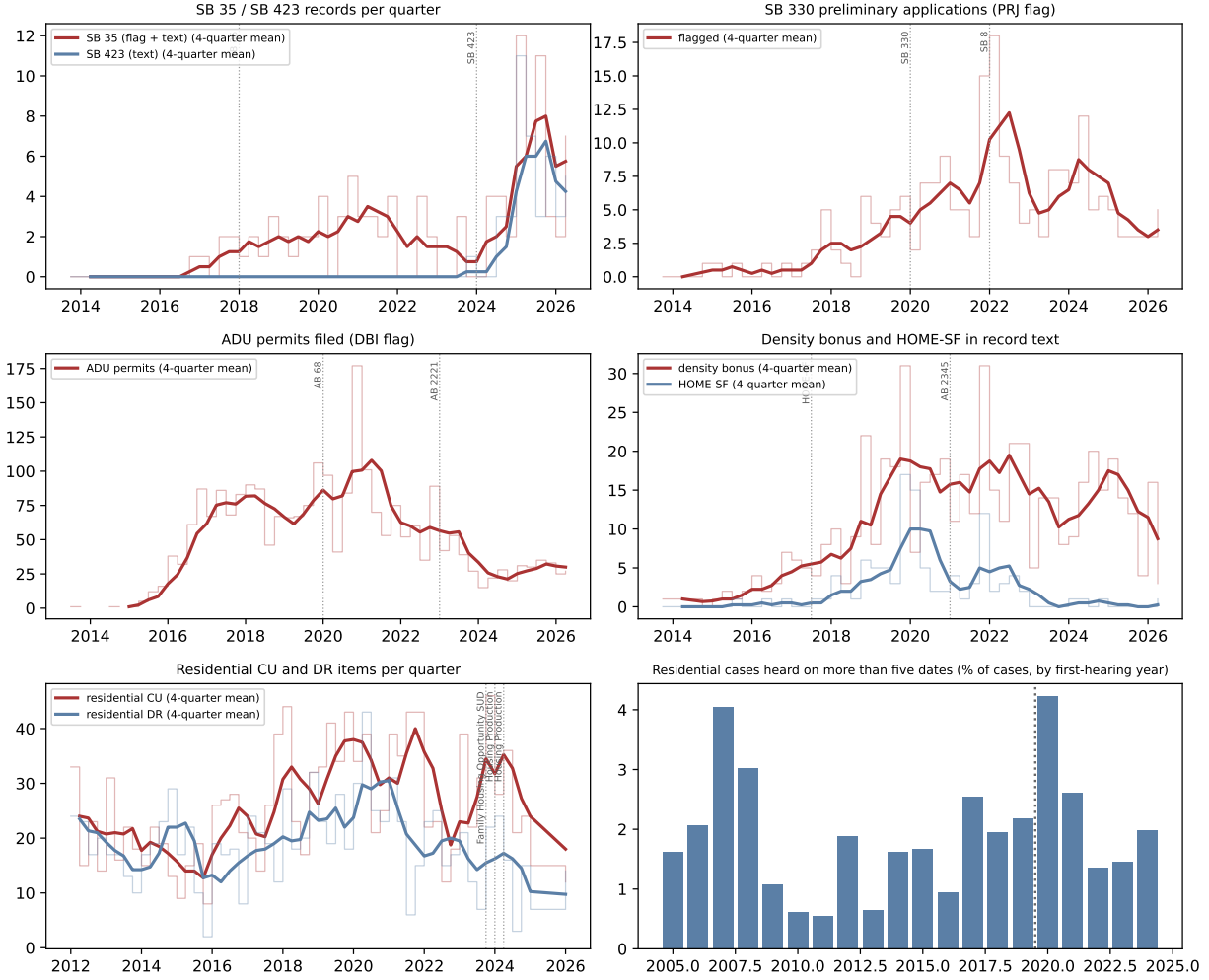


Figure 1: First stages, per quarter where the data counts them: faint, quarterly; bold, four-quarter mean; dotted lines, the laws' effective or operative dates. Records and permits run to the last complete quarter before retrieval. The last panel counts, for residential cases, the share heard on more than five distinct dates, by the year of the first hearing; recent years are right-censored.

- **Density bonus and HOME-SF.** Density-bonus mentions rise after HOME-SF’s adoption (2017-07-13) and stay; HOME-SF’s own rise and then fall away.

7 The diversion series

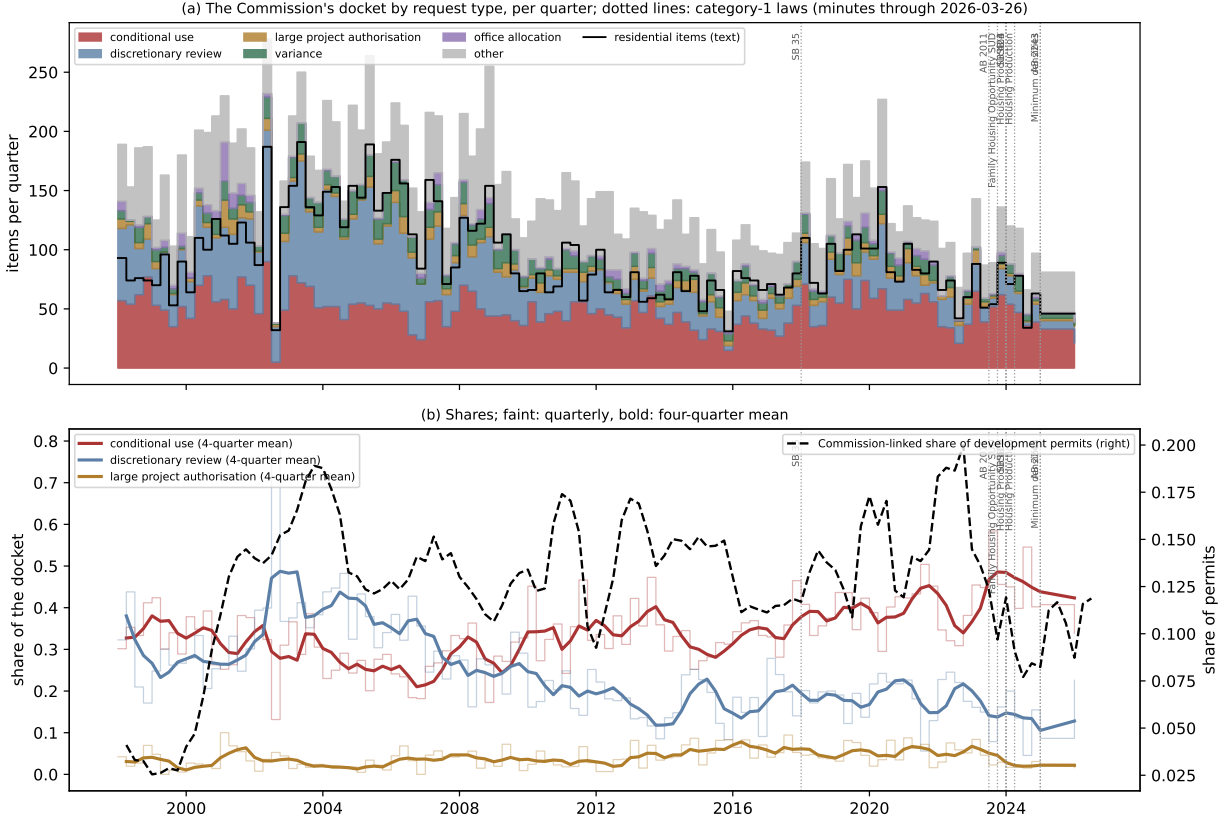


Figure 2: (a) The Commission’s docket by request type, per quarter, 1998Q1–2026Q1, with residential items (items whose description mentions dwelling units, housing or residential use) as a line. (b) Shares of conditional use, discretionary review and large project authorisations, and the share of development-relevant DBI permits that are Commission-linked, by filing quarter. Dotted lines: the category-1 laws.

If a law diverts projects out of the discretionary track, the docket that remains changes character, and every time series measured on it — in every memo — is measured on a shifting sample. Figure 2 is that check.

The docket averaged 111 items a quarter in 2021–2022 and 91 in 2024–2026. Residential conditional uses went from 29.4 to 22.7 a quarter and residential discretionary reviews from 19.4 to 13.2. The break follows Ordinance 248-23 (effective 2024-01-14) and Ordinance 53-24 (2024-04-22), which exempted specified housing projects from Section 311 notice and from the conditional-use requirement; it also coincides with the interest-rate cycle and the Housing Element rezoning. The permit-side share of development-relevant permits that are Commission-linked was 13.1% in 2005–2009 and 14.3% in 2020–2025.

The practical consequence: analyses on the hearing docket should be split at the Housing

Production ordinances, and a comparison of hearing outcomes across that date compares different projects.

8 The 25-unit ordinance of July 2026

The permits memo drew a line at 25 units for “the July 2026 ordinance”, a figure from the brief that memo did not check. It is checked here. The Board lists 131 ordinances for 2026, through Ordinance 0133-26 (effective 2026-08-23); 0 of their titles mention the inclusionary program or a 25-unit threshold. The ordinances touching housing in 2026 are a transit-oriented alternative plan under SB 79 (Ordinance 82-26), special use districts, a tenant-protection ordinance and a definitions ordinance. Unless the ordinance meant is not an ordinance (a Commission resolution or a Planning Department bulletin), or is not yet on the list, the 25-unit line has no source; the row stays in the inventory, unverified. The 25-unit tier that the inclusionary program has had since Proposition C (exactions memo) is a candidate for what was meant.

9 Established and not established

Established.

1. The inventory: 45 laws with chapters, approval dates, sunsets and the laws’ own statements of what they do, every claim verified against a primary source.
2. The classification: 9 laws move the arrival of discretion, 10 the delay given discretion; 19 are opt-in pathways.
3. The docket’s residential conditional-use and discretionary-review items fell after the Housing Production ordinances.
4. No 2026 ordinance on the Board’s list, through Ordinance 0133-26, matches a 25-unit ordinance of July 2026.

Not established.

1. The effective dates of 18 statutes (inferred from the pattern of the history notes, not read).
2. Whether any law caused the movements the series show; this memo does not ask.
3. The treated sets of the opt-in pathways, and eligibility under any of them.
4. Whether SB 330’s hearing cap binds: the hearings it counts are not identified.
5. Which Priority Equity Geographies parcels the Housing Production exemptions excluded (the polygon is not yet joined).

10 Reproducing this

```
cd code/commission_minutes_processing
python audit_state_laws.py fetch      # every cited source; sf.gov’s 2026 list
python audit_state_laws.py claims    # law_claims.csv
python audit_state_laws.py probe     # verify every quotation
```

```
python audit_state_laws.py build      # inventory, populations, series
python audit_state_laws.py report     # tables, figures, macros
```

Outputs: law_inventory.csv and law_claims.csv beside this memo;
\$MFHR_DATA_ROOT/external/laws/ (the checked claims and the quarterly series). The source
cache is build.exaction.panel.py's, under external/legal/.